

Zacchaeus the Tax Collector

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Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories - Book 16

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For all the children who know that Jesus loves everyone and can change any heart.

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Page 2

[PICTURE: People turning away from Zacchaeus, looking angry and annoyed, nobody wanting to be his friend. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Nobody liked Zacchaeus. People called him a cheat and a thief. He had no friends. Even though he was rich, he was very lonely and sad inside.

TIGRINYA:

ገላላ'ገ ስጋጋጋጋ ስጋጋጋጋ ስጋጋጋ ስጋጋ ስጋጋጋ ስጋጋጋ ስጋጋጋ ስጋጋጋ ስጋጋጋጋጋጋ
ገላላ'ገ ስጋጋጋጋ ስጋጋጋ ስጋጋ ስጋጋጋጋ ስጋጋጋ ስጋጋጋ

(Pronunciation: ስጋጋ = t'ebari = cheat, ስጋጋ = seraq = thief, ስጋጋጋ = beynawi = lonely)

Page 4

[PICTURE: Zacchaeus trying to see over the crowd but he is too short, jumping up and down, people blocking his view. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Zacchaeus really wanted to see Jesus too! But he was too short. He jumped and jumped but could not see over the tall crowd. Everyone was in his way!

TIGRINYA:

ገራጽ'ገራ ገራጽ ገራጽ ገራጽ! ገራ ገራ ገራ ገራጽ ገራጽ ገራጽ ገራ ገራ ገራ
ገራጽ ገራ ገራ ገራጽገራጽ ገራ ገራ ገራጽ ገራጽ!

(Pronunciation: ገራጽ = Hats'ir = short, ገራጽ = zelele = jumped, ገራጽ = newiHat = tall)

Page 5

[PICTURE: Zacchaeus getting a clever idea, spotting a big sycamore tree near the road, starting to run toward it. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Then Zacchaeus had an idea! He saw a big sycamore tree by the road. "If I climb that tree, I can see Jesus!" he thought. So he ran ahead to the tree.

TIGRINYA:

ገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገ ገገገ! ገገ ገገ ገገገገ ገገገ ገገ ገገገ ገገገገ "ገገ ገገ ገገገ ገገገገ
ገገገገ ገገገ ገገገገ!" ገገገገ ገገገ ገገገ ገገ ገገገ ገገገ

(Pronunciation: ገገ = om = tree, ገገገ = sagla = sycamore, ገገገገ = deyibe = climb)

Page 6

[PICTURE: Zacchaeus climbing up the sycamore tree, his fine robes getting tangled, determined to get to the top branches. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Zacchaeus climbed up the tree as fast as he could! His fancy clothes got dirty but he did not care. He climbed higher and higher until he had a perfect view of the road.

TIGRINYA:

ገረግረጌ ገረግረጌ ገረግረጌ ገረ ገረ ገረግረጌ! ገረግ ገረግ ገረግረጌ ገረ ገረግ ገረግረግረጌ ገረግረጌ
ገረግ ገረግረጌ ገረ ገረግ ገረግረጌ ገረግ ገረግ ገረግረጌ

(Pronunciation: ገረግ = deyeba = climbed it, ገረግረጌ = qilt'afe = fast, ገረግ = li'ili = higher)

Page 7

[PICTURE: Zacchaeus sitting happily on a branch of the sycamore tree, looking down at the road, waiting excitedly for Jesus. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Zacchaeus sat on a branch and waited. From up high, he could see everything! His heart was beating fast. He was so excited to see Jesus walking this way.

TIGRINYA:

ጸጸጸጸ ጸጸ ጸጸጸጸ ጸጸ ጸጸ ጸጸጸጸ ጸጸ ጸጸጸ ጸጸ ጸጸጸ ጸጸጸጸ ጸጸጸ! ጸጸ ጸጸጸጸጸ ጸጸጸጸጸ
ጸጸጸ ጸጸጸ ጸጸጸጸ ጸጸ ጸጸጸ ጸጸጸ ጸጸጸጸ ጸጸጸጸ

(Pronunciation: ጸጸጸጸ = chenfer = branch, ጸጸጸ = la'ili = up high, ጸጸ = libu = his heart)

Page 8

[PICTURE: Jesus walking along the road with a crowd following Him, approaching the sycamore tree where Zacchaeus is hiding. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Jesus came walking down the road with many people following Him. He smiled and talked to everyone. Then He stopped right under Zacchaeus's tree!

TIGRINYA:

ገጃስ ገጃስ ገጃስ ገጃስገጃስ ገጃ ገጃስ ገጃስ ገጃስ ገጃስ ገጃስ ገጃ ገጃስ ገጃስ ገጃስ
ገጃስ ገጃ ገጃስ ገጃ ገጃስ ገጃ ገጃ!

(Pronunciation: ገጃስ = kikeyd = walking, ገጃስ = fishikh = smiled, ገጃ ገጃ = dew bele = stopped)

Page 9

[PICTURE: Jesus looking up into the tree, smiling directly at Zacchaeus with warm loving eyes, everyone watching in surprise. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Jesus looked up into the tree and smiled! He knew Zacchaeus was there! "Zacchaeus!" Jesus called. "Come down quickly! I want to visit your house today!"

TIGRINYA:

ገጃጃ ገጃ ገጃጃ ገጃጃ ገጃ ገጃጃ ገጃጃ ገጃ ገጃ! ገጃጃጃ ገጃጃ ገጃጃጃ ገጃጃ ገጃጃ! "ገጃጃጃጃ!"
ገጃጃ ገጃጃጃ "ገጃጃጃጃጃ ገጃጃ! ገጃ ገጃጃ ገጃጃጃ ገጃጃ!"

(Pronunciation: ገጃጃ = ts'ew'e = called, ገጃጃጃጃ = qelt'ifka = quickly, ገጃጃ = wured = come down)

Page 10

[PICTURE: Zacchaeus looking shocked and overjoyed up in the tree, pointing at himself in disbelief that Jesus knows his name. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Zacchaeus could not believe it! Jesus knew his name! Jesus wanted to come to HIS house! Nobody ever wanted to visit Zacchaeus before. His heart was so happy!

TIGRINYA:

፳፻፳፻ ፳፻፳፻ ፳፻፳፻፳፻! ፳፻፻ ፳፻ ፳፻፳፻! ፳፻፻ ፳፻ ፳፻፻ ፳፻፳፻ ፳፻፻! ፳፻፻ ፳፻'፳ ፳፻'፳
፳፻፳፻፻ ፳፻፳፻ ፳፻፳፻ ፳፻፳፻፳፻፻ ፳፻ ፳፻፻ ፳፻፳፻!

(Pronunciation: ፳፻ = simu = his name, ፳፻፻ = gez'u = his house, ፳፻ = libu = his heart)

Page 11

[PICTURE: Zacchaeus scrambling down the tree quickly with excitement, nearly falling in his hurry to reach Jesus. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Zacchaeus hurried down from the tree as fast as he could! He almost fell because he was so excited! He ran to Jesus with the biggest smile on his face.

TIGRINYA:

ወደብ ወደብወደብ ወደብ ወደ ቤት ወደብ! ወደብ ወደብ ወደብ ወደ ቤት ወደብ! ወደብ ወደብ ወደብ
ወደ ቤት ወደ ቤት ወደብ ወደብ

(Pronunciation: ወደብ = werede = came down, ወደብ = Hagos = excitement, ወደብ = goye = ran)

Page 12

[PICTURE: The crowd looking angry and whispering to each other, upset that Jesus would visit a sinful tax collector. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

But the crowd was angry! "Why would Jesus visit that terrible man?" they whispered. "He is a cheater and a sinner! He does not deserve Jesus's time!"

TIGRINYA:

ገገ ገገ ገገገ ገገገ! "ገገገ ገገገገገገ ገገ ገገገ ገገ ገገገገ?" ገገገገገገ ገገገገገገ "ገገ
ገገገገ ገገገገገገገ'ገ! ገገ ገገገ ገገገገገገገ!"

(Pronunciation: ገገገ = Hariqu = angry, ገገገገገገ = aHshushu = whispered, ገገገገገገገ = Hat'i'atenya = sinner)

Page 15

[PICTURE: Zacchaeus's face changing from shame to joy as Jesus's love touches his heart, tears forming in his eyes. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

As Zacchaeus spent time with Jesus, something amazing happened in his heart. He felt sorry for all the bad things he had done. Jesus's love was changing him from the inside!

TIGRINYA:

ፍጹሙ ስህ ስህ ስህ ፍጹሙ ስህ ስህ ስህ ፍጹሙ ስህ ስህ ስህ ፍጹሙ ስህ ስህ ስህ
ፍጹሙ ስህ ስህ ስህ ስህ ፍጹሙ ስህ!

(Pronunciation: ስህ = libu = heart, ፍጹሙ = zedenq = amazing, ስህ ስህ ስህ = yiqiyyro = changing him)

Page 16

[PICTURE: Zacchaeus standing up boldly, hands on his heart, making a promise to Jesus with a sincere expression. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Zacchaeus stood up and said to Jesus, "Lord! I will give half of everything I own to the poor! And if I have cheated anyone, I will pay them back four times as much!"

TIGRINYA:

ገረጸጸ ገረጸጸ ገረጸጸ "ገረጸጸ! ገረጸ ገረ ገረጸ ገረጸጸጸ ገረጸ'ጸ! ገረጸጸ ገረ ገረጸ ገረጸጸ ገረ
ገረጸጸጸ ገረጸ ገረጸጸጸ'ጸ!" ገረጸ

(Pronunciation: ገረጸጸ = diKatat = poor, ገረጸ = t'ebire = cheated, ገረጸጸጸ ገረጸ = arba'ite 'its'fi = four times)

Page 17

[PICTURE: Jesus smiling with joy at Zacchaeus's changed heart, a warm light surrounding them both in the room. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Jesus was so happy! He smiled at Zacchaeus and said, "Today salvation has come to this house! This is why I came - to find and save people who are lost."

TIGRINYA:

ገጃጃ ገጃጃ ገጃጃጃ! ገጃ ገጃጃጃ ገጃጃ ገጃ "ገጃ ገጃጃጃ ገጃ'ገ ገጃ ገጃጃ! ገጃ'ገ'ገ ገጃጃጃጃ - ገጃጃጃ ገጃጃ ገጃጃጃጃጃ ገጃጃጃጃጃ" ገጃጃ

(Pronunciation: ገጃጃጃ = midHan = salvation, ገጃጃጃ = zit'ef'u = lost, ገጃጃጃጃ = nimirkab = to find)

[PICTURE: Zacchaeus giving bags of money and food to poor people, children and families receiving his gifts with surprise and joy. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Zacchaeus kept his promise! He gave away much of his money to poor people. He gave food to hungry families. His heart was now full of love instead of greed.

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 00 000 000 0000 000 0000

(Pronunciation: $\square\square\square\square = qalu\ Halewe = kept\ his\ promise$, $\square\square\square\square = diKatat = poor$, $\square\square\square = sis'e = greed$)

Page 19

[PICTURE: Zacchaeus returning money to people he had cheated, them looking surprised and forgiving him, shaking hands. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Zacchaeus went to everyone he had cheated. "I am sorry," he said. "Here is your money back - and even more!" People were so surprised at the new Zacchaeus!

TIGRINYA:

ገገገገ ገገ ገገ ገገገገ ገገ ገገገ "ገገገገ" ገገገ "ገገገገገገ ገገገገ - ገገገ'ገገ!" ገገገ
ገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገገገ!

(Pronunciation: ገገገገ = zit'ebero = he cheated, ገገገገ = yiqireta = sorry, ገገገገ = yimeles = is returned)

Page 20

[PICTURE: People in the community now smiling at Zacchaeus, shaking his hand, children playing near him, accepted and loved. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Now people liked Zacchaeus! He made friends and was kind to everyone. He was still short, but his heart was now the biggest in all of Jericho!

TIGRINYA:

ብሉ ወይን ወይን ወይን! ወይን ወይን ወይን ወይ ወይን ወይን ወይ ወይን'ኦ ወይን ወይ ወይ
ወይ ወይ ወይ ወይ ወይን ወይ!

(Pronunciation: ወይን = fetewuwo = liked him, ወይን = meHazut = friends, ወይ = lewah = kind)

Page 21

[PICTURE: Zacchaeus and his new friends helping others together in the community, showing his completely changed life. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Zacchaeus's whole life changed because of Jesus! He went from being selfish and mean to being generous and kind. Jesus's love had transformed him completely.

TIGRINYA:

፳፻፱ ፳፻፱ ፳፻፱ ፳፻፱ ፳፻፱ ፳፻፱! ፳፻ ፳፻፱፱፱፱ ፳፻፱ ፳፻ ፳፻፱ ፳፻፱ ፳፻፱፱፱፱
፳፻፱ ፳፻፱ ፳፻፱፱ ፳፻፱፱፱፱

(Pronunciation: ፳፻፱፱ = teqeyere = changed, ፳፻፱ = legas = generous, ፳፻፱ = fiqri = love)

Page 22

[PICTURE: Jesus with open arms welcoming all kinds of people - short, tall, rich, poor - showing He loves everyone equally. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Jesus loves everyone - even people others don't like! Jesus doesn't care if you are short or tall, rich or poor. He sees your heart and He loves you just as you are.

TIGRINYA:

ገጽ ገጽ ህጻናት - ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ! ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ
ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ

(Pronunciation: ገጽ ገጽ = kulu seb = everyone, ገጽ = libKa = your heart, ገጽ ገጽ = yifet'weKa = loves you)

Page 23

[PICTURE: A child sharing toys with another child, being kind and generous, showing how Jesus changes our hearts too. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

When Jesus comes into our hearts, He changes us! He makes us want to share, be kind, and help others. We become new and better people because of His love.

TIGRINYA:

ገገግ ሰጠ ሰጠ ሰጠ ሰጠ ሰጠጠጠ! ሰጠጠጠ ሰጠጠ ሰጠጠጠ ሰጠጠጠ ሰጠ ሰጠጠጠ ሰጠጠ
 ሰጠጠጠጠ ሰጠጠ ሰጠጠጠ ሰጠጠ ሰጠ ሰጠጠጠ

(Pronunciation: ሰጠ = libna = our hearts, ሰጠጠጠ = yiqiyrena = changes us, ሰጠጠጠ = kinkafel = to share)

Page 24

[PICTURE: A child looking up at a tree with a smile, remembering the story of Zacchaeus, feeling loved by Jesus. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Next time you see a tree, remember Zacchaeus! Remember that Jesus knows YOUR name too. He loves you and wants to be part of your life every single day.

TIGRINYA:

ግግግግ ግግ ግግ ግግ ግግግግ ግግግግ ግግግ! ግግግ ግግግግግግ'ግግ ግግ ግግግግ ግግግግግግግ
ግግግግግግ ግግ ግግግግ ግግ ግግግግግግ ግግግግ ግግ ግግግግ

(Pronunciation: ግግ = om = tree, ግግግግ = simkum = your name, ግግግግግግ = hiyiwetkum = your life)

[PICTURE: Zacchaeus and Jesus standing under the sycamore tree together, both smiling, with the whole community around them in peace. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Remember: Jesus loves everyone and it is never too late to change! When we let Jesus into our hearts, He helps us become kind, generous, and loving. Jesus changes everything!

000000: 000 000 00 0000 000000 00 000 000000! 0000 00 000 00
0000 0000 0000 0000 000000 000000 000 000 0000!

(Pronunciation: $\square\square\square\square$ = nikulu seb = everyone, $\square\square\square\square$ = nimqiyar = to change, $\square\square\square\square$ = yiHgzena = helps us)

English: Jesus loves everyone, no matter what they have done. When we meet Jesus and let His love into our hearts, He changes us and makes us want to do good. It is never too late to say sorry and start doing what is right.

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Bible Verse / ቅዱስ መጽሐፍ ቅዱስ

English: "For the Son of Man came to seek and to save the lost." - Luke 19:10

Tigrinya: "ቅዱስ ሰው ለመጽሐፍ ቅዱስ ለመጽሐፍ ቅዱስ" - ሉቃ 19:10

Talk About It / ማግኘት'ህ ማግኘት

1. Why did Zacchaeus climb the tree? / ማግኘት ማግኘት'ህ ማግኘት?
2. What did Jesus say to Zacchaeus? / ማግኘት ማግኘት ማግኘት ማግኘት?
3. How did Zacchaeus change after meeting Jesus? / ማግኘት ማግኘት ማግኘት ማግኘት ማግኘት?
4. How can Jesus change your heart too? / ማግኘት ማግኘት'ህ ማግኘት ማግኘት ማግኘት?

English: Dear Jesus, thank You for loving me just as I am. Please come into my heart and change me to be kind and generous like Zacchaeus became. Help me to share with others and do what is right. Amen.

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Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories Series

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1. ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ - Baby Moses in the Basket
2. ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ - David and Goliath
3. ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ - The Good Samaritan
4. ሰፊ ሰፊ - ሰፊ ሰፊ - Noah's Ark
5. ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ - Daniel in the Lions' Den
6. ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ - Joseph's Colorful Coat
7. ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ - Jonah and the Big Fish
8. ሰፊ 5,000 ሰፊ ሰፊ - Jesus Feeds 5,000 People
9. ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ - The Lost Sheep
10. ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ - Jesus Calms the Storm
11. ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ - Queen Esther's Courage
12. ሰፊ ሰፊ - Ruth and Naomi
13. ሰፊ - ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ - Creation
14. ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ - The Prodigal Son
15. ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ - Elijah and Fire from Heaven
16. ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ - **Zacchaeus the Tax Collector** ፤
17. ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ - Abraham and Isaac
18. ሰፊ ሰፊ - The Tower of Babel
19. ሰፊ ሰፊ-ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ - Jesus Heals Blind Bartimaeus
20. ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ ሰፊ - Jesus Heals Ten Lepers